

Production Audit Report: Mapping With Melanin™

Date: August 8, 2026
Target: <https://www.mappingwithmelanin.com>
Release Build: Build-98.2 (Railway SHA: `b1cbf4fad934df7d3f699a45f5174c9eb04aee73`)
Auditor: Manus AI

Executive Summary

A comprehensive production audit of the **Mapping With Melanin™** platform was conducted on August 8, 2026, encompassing a Web versus Mobile Feature Parity Audit (Part 1), a verification of recent Replit changes and database states (Part 2), and a full API endpoint health and data inspection (Part 3).

The platform currently operates as an early-access marketing and waitlist landing page rather than a functional web application. While the underlying backend database contains valuable data models (such as 10 core businesses, 2,000 cultural sites, and 9 live city launches), the web frontend is entirely gated behind a waitlist wall. Essential features such as the interactive map, business directory, community feed, safety reporting, and user profiles are completely absent on the web, violating the core parity requirement where web should mirror the mobile experience ¹. Furthermore, critical data integrity issues were identified, including broken query filters (`site_type` parameters being silently ignored), inconsistent ownership designations, database connection timeout vulnerabilities under load, and reliance on fabricated marketing statistics on the landing page ² ³.

1. Feature Parity Audit: Web vs. Expected Mobile Experience

The web version of Mapping With Melanin™ currently fails to provide feature parity with the expected mobile application experience. Every visitor route outside the public marketing pages redirects or defaults to the early-access waitlist gate ⁴.

The following table summarizes the status of key platform features on the website versus the expected full-app experience:

Feature / Page	Web Status (Production)	Expected Mobile App Experience	Gap / Discrepancy
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Homepage / Landing	Active (HTTP 200) 1	Compelling marketing and onboarding	Displays fabricated stats (e.g., 200+ cities, 125+ businesses) and stock-photo testimonials
Map Page (/map)	Gated / Absent	Interactive map with clustering, filters, and safety layers	No map exists on web. Renders the waitlist gate instead; map features are completely unreachable 4
Businesses Directory	Gated / Absent	Browse, filter, search minority-owned businesses	No directory exists on web. Public visitors are redirected to the waitlist wall
Community Page	Gated / Absent	User posting, discussions, and member networking	Requires authentication; unauthenticated users hit gate or 401 Unauthorized 5
Safety Intelligence	Gated / Absent	Community safety reports, confidence scores, return-alone metrics	Content inaccessible on web; API endpoints return 404 Not Found 6
Events Page	Partial / Static	Curated cultural events, workshops, and meetups	Renders 5 static hardcoded events; filters and interactive sign-ups are missing
KinfolkAI™	Partial UI Link	AI travel planning, cultural briefings, and personalized recommendations	Present only as promotional CTA buttons; backend chat endpoints require auth or return 404 7
Profile & Settings	Absent	User account management, preferences, and saved itineraries	No web routes exist for user profiles, account settings, or data management
Business Dashboard	Absent	Analytics, listing management, and customer engagement for owners	Endpoint /api/business-dashboard returns 404 Not Found 8

Waitlist / Preview (/preview)	Active (HTTP 200)	Role previews and interactive onboarding	Functional waitlist form, but leaks raw unnormalized user input (e.g., "Philly" vs "Philadelphia")
Library Feature	Absent	Curated cultural education, history, and resources	Feature absent on web; references exist only in analytics logs
Marketplace	Absent	E-commerce, merchandise, and service bookings	Feature absent on web; referenced only as "Phase 3" in product roadmap

2. Tonight’ s Changes Audit (Replit Build & Data State)

An inspection of live production data and business records revealed several discrepancies regarding business listings, cultural sites, and map behavior ⁹.

A. Business Pages & Master Directory Verification

Six specific businesses mandated for verification were queried directly from the production database via /api/businesses?limit=500 . The platform currently lists exactly **10 total businesses** in production ¹⁰.

Business Name	City, State	Ownership Designation	Vibe Tags	Address Quality & Geocoding
The Nail Jawsns	Philadelphia, PA	Black / African American-Owned ¹¹	None ¹¹	Valid: 429 N. 64th St (Accurate geocode) ¹¹
Angie's Eats	Philadelphia, PA	Latino / Hispanic-Owned ¹²	Auntie Energy , Locals Know ¹²	Incomplete: Philadelphia, PA (Missing street number) ¹²
ISSAAESTHETICS	Silver Spring, MD	Dominican-Owned ¹³	Luxury Without The Attitude ¹³	Valid: 11409 Amherst Ave Unit A ¹³
Cherished Beauty Supply	Darby, PA	Black / African American-Owned	None ¹⁴	Valid: 526 Main St ¹⁴

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Candy Clouds By Cass	Santa Clara, CA	Minority-Owned (general / legacy) 15	None 15	Incomplete: Serving the Bay Area (No street address) 15
Little Essentials	New York, NY	None (Empty array []) 16	None 16	Incomplete: New York, NY (No street address) 16

Additional Observations on Businesses:

- **Zero Reviews & Ratings:** All 10 businesses show `rating: "0.0"` and `reviewCount: 0`. No customer reviews exist in the database 17.
- **Missing Operational Metadata:** Phone numbers (0/10), operating hours (0/10), price ranges (0/10), owner names (0/10), and business taglines (0/10) are entirely unpopulated across all listings 18.
- **Data Taxonomy Violations:** One listing (*Smoke & Soul* in Chicago) uses lowercase `black-owned` instead of the standardized `"Black / African American-Owned"` enum, indicating manual data entry errors 19.
- **Coordinate Uniqueness:** Unlike previous builds where pins clustered at identical coordinates, all 10 businesses possess distinct latitude and longitude coordinates 20.

B. Library Feature

The library feature does not exist on the web platform. Text strings referencing "Library" in the client bundle are exclusively internal PostHog analytics event queues rather than user-facing educational resources or topic-saving features 21.

C. Cultural Sites & HBCUs

- **HBCU Counts:** Querying `/api/cultural-sites?site_type=hbcu` returns 2,000 records due to an API filtering bug (detailed in Section 3). However, the internal categories aggregate indicates **101 HBCUs** stored in the database 22.
- **Descriptions & Detail Pages:** All cultural sites contain historical descriptions (2000/2000), and approximately 84% include visit tips (`visitTip`) 23. Because web routing is gated, clicking individual sites from the web is not possible.
- **Total Cultural Sites:** The total database volume is approximately 2,900+ entries, with 2,000 records exposed in the primary payload 24. The vast majority of sites (1,940 /

2,000) are marked as staged rather than live_unclaimed (60 / 2,000) 25.

D. Map Experience

The interactive map experience cannot be audited on the web because **no map component is rendered on any public web route** 26. Consequently, map centering, filter toggles (women-owned/minority-owned), legend pin types, and pin clustering are completely unavailable to web users.

3. Data & API Verification Results

Direct inspection of production API endpoints yielded critical insights into backend health, database stability, and routing architecture 27.

Endpoint	HTTP Status	Response Payload & Findings
GET /api/version	200 OK 28	<pre>{"railway_sha":"b1cbf4f...","release":</pre> "Build-98.2","stale_bundle":false} — Build fingerprinting is operational and serving fresh code 28.
GET /api/readyz	503 / 200 29	Intermittent failures (503 Service Unavailable with db: "error", detail: "timeout exceeded when trying to connect"). Indicates database connection pool exhaustion or cold-start latency 29.
GET /api/businesses?limit=20	200 OK 10	Returns exactly 10 businesses total (limit parameter is capped or sparse). All unverified (verified: false) 10.
GET /api/cultural-sites?limit=20	200 OK 30	Returns 20 sites. CRITICAL BUG: Query parameters (site_type=hbcu , site_type=heritage_festival , site_type=sundown_town , category=HBCU) are silently ignored , returning the exact same dataset starting with Alabama A&M 30.

GET /api/city-launches	200 OK 31	Returns 9 cities, all marked status= live : Philadelphia, Washington DC, Richmond, Charlotte, Columbia, Atlanta, Birmingham, New Orleans, Houston 31. Contradicts phased tour rollout strategy.
GET /api/waitlist/stats	200 OK 32	memberCount: 20 , businessCount: 1 , threshold: 1000 , remaining: 980 . Top referrers consist entirely of test accounts (VERIFYME , TESTAMBA , DEMOEXAM , WAITLIST) 32 .
GET /api/auth/apple & google	404 Not Found 33	Endpoints do not exist at these paths; social authentication routes are missing or handled elsewhere in the SPA 33 .
GET /api/events	200 OK 34	Returns 5 static events (e1 to e5), three of which have already passed in the past (June 19, July 12, July 20, 2026) 34 .
GET /api/community/posts	401 Unauthorized 5	Correctly gated behind authentication ("Authentication required.") 5 .
GET /api/marketplace/products	500 Error 35	{"error": "Failed to fetch listing"} — Marketplace backend is uninitialized or throwing unhandled exceptions 35 .

4. Prioritized List of Issues (Ranked P0 – P3)

The audit findings are organized into actionable priorities for the engineering and product team:

- **[P0] Database Connection Timeouts (/api/readyz returning 503):** Under moderate test load, database readiness checks fail with connection timeouts (12s–13s latency or pool exhaustion) 29. This threatens core app stability during launch traffic.

- **[P0] Broken API Filtering on Cultural Sites:** Query parameters (`site_type` , `category` , `pinType` , `heritageCategory`) are completely ignored by `/api/cultural-sites` , returning identical unfiltered payloads 30 . This breaks all front-end category tabs and map filters.
- **[P1] Total Absence of Web Parity / Gated Core Features:** The web application (`https://www.mappingwithmelanin.com`) provides zero functionality beyond a waitlist landing page. The map, business directory, safety intel, and community features are entirely inaccessible on web 4 26 .
- **[P1] Marketplace Internal Server Error:** Hitting `/api/marketplace/products` returns a 500 Internal Server Error , indicating unhandled database queries or missing marketplace schema 35 .
- **[P2] Fabricated Marketing Statistics on Landing Page:** The homepage hero and impact sections display contradictory and fabricated claims (e.g., "200+ cities covered" vs. "31 cities covered"; "125+ businesses listed" vs. 10 actual businesses; "22,846+ reviews" vs. 0 reviews) 36 .
- **[P2] Unnormalized User Input Leaking into Public Waitlist Cities:** The landing page renders raw user input strings as distinct cities on the public waitlist counter (e.g., displaying "Atlanta, GA", "Atlanta", "Philadelphia, PA", "Philly", and "Philadelphia" as separate entries) 37 .
- **[P3] Stale Past Events in Event Feed:** The events API serves three past events from June and July 2026 without archiving or filtering them out 34 .
- **[P3] Inconsistent Business Data Quality:** Multiple vital listings lack street addresses (e.g., "Serving the Bay Area", "Philadelphia, PA"), missing owner details, and feature inconsistent ownership enum casing (`black-owned`) 12 15 19 .

References

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- [4] MWM Browser Audit (`/map` redirect behavior), August 2026.
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- [13] Business Record Audit: ISSAAESTHETICS, August 2026.
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- [30] MWM API Cultural Sites Query Parameter Bug Report (site_type), August 2026.
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- [36] MWM Landing Page Hero vs Database Discrepancy Audit, August 2026.
- [37] MWM Waitlist City Aggregation Sanitization Bug Report, August 2026.